

PROPOSAL • WEBSITE, CONTENT & SEARCH • SEPTEMBER 2026

PUT THE WORK ON THE **RECORD.**

A new pedersenhaupt.com: designed, built, photographed and written in ten weeks, with the firm's own work as the content.

PREPARED FOR

Pedersen & Houpt, P.C.

PREPARED BY

Upperhand, Chicago

FIXED FEE

\$50,000

LAUNCH

Week 10



THE SHORT VERSION

TEN WEEKS

kickoff to launch

\$50,000

fixed, itemized below

THREE PAYMENTS

tied to work you've seen

ONE SHOOT DAY

at 161 North Clark

SIX ARTICLES

live on launch day

THE FIRM IS BETTER THAN ITS WEBSITE.

Brian, Anthony, and the partners,

Pedersen & Houpt has spent sixty-nine years on work that rarely makes it onto the page. Counsel to the buyer of the Thompson Center. Counsel to a Chicago steel-drum maker through its sale. A first Chambers ranking this summer. Your website carries almost none of it, and what it does carry sits on a design from 2012, refreshed once in 2021.

We're proposing one project with a start and an end. A new site. A day of photography at 161 North Clark. The copy and search work underneath it. And the first six articles, written from matters you've already closed and already made public.

Ten weeks from kickoff to launch, for one fixed price, paid in three parts tied to work you can see. Everything we say about your current site comes from our September audit of it. Where we say something is missing, we checked.

John Williamson

CO-FOUNDER, UPPERHAND

Greg McDonald

CO-FOUNDER, UPPERHAND

WHAT THIS HAS TO DO.

1

LOOK LIKE THE FIRM.

For most new clients and every lateral hire, the site is the first meeting. It should read like 161 North Clark, not a template. The people and the matters lead.

2

GET FOUND.

When someone searches for a Chicago business or real estate firm, the site should answer with a written title, a fast page and a Google profile the firm actually controls.

3

STAY CURRENT.

A site is only as current as its last post. We build a publishing habit the firm can keep, starting with six articles on launch day.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

Measured on your site today, in September. Every number on the left is from our audit.

MEASURE

TODAY

AT LAUNCH

Phone load time

LARGEST ELEMENT ON SCREEN, LIGHTHOUSE

~~2.8 to 7.8 s~~

→ under 2.5 s

Pages with a written title and description

~~2 of 169~~

→ Every page

Homepage weight

~~2.4 MB~~

→ under 1 MB

Google Business Profile

~~2.8 stars, 4 reviews, appears
unclaimed~~

→ Claimed, verified, photographed

MEASURE

TODAY

AT LAUNCH

Attorney portraits

~~4 backdrops across 6 partners~~

→ One light, every attorney

Articles since April 2022

0

→ 6 live, then monthly

Accessibility

~~Contrast failures on desktop~~

→ WCAG 2.2 AA, every template

WITHIN THE FIRST YEAR, WE
MEASURE

- Inquiries you can count: form, calls and newsletter sign-ups, tracked from day one.
- Twenty practice searches we agree on in discovery, checked every month.
- A publishing rhythm the firm keeps without being chased.

DESIGN. BUILD. TUNE. **FILL.**

Four jobs, done by the same two people who wrote this proposal. The fourth is the one most rebuilds leave out.

DESIGN

WEBSITE DESIGN

A design system built from the firm's own world: the tombstone, the building, the record. It starts from the Matter of record direction in our audit and becomes seven templates for desktop and phone.

- + Design system: type, color, components
- + Home, practice, attorney, matter, article, about and careers, contact
- + A prototype you can click before we build
- + Two rounds of revisions

BUILD

WEBSITE DEVELOPMENT

A fast, secure site your team edits without calling anyone. Everything on the old site moves over, and every old address keeps working.

- + A CMS for bios, matters and articles
- + Every page, bio and archived publication migrated
- + A redirect for every old URL
- + LawPay, client login, newsletter and forms carried over

TUNE

OPTIMIZATION

Speed, search and access, measured before and after, so the improvement is a number and not an opinion.

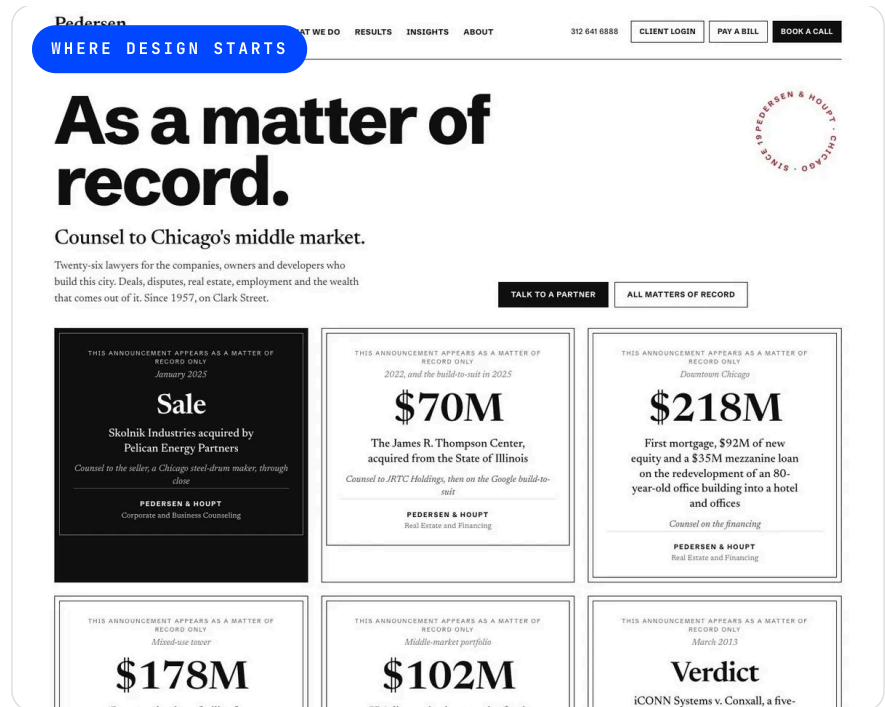
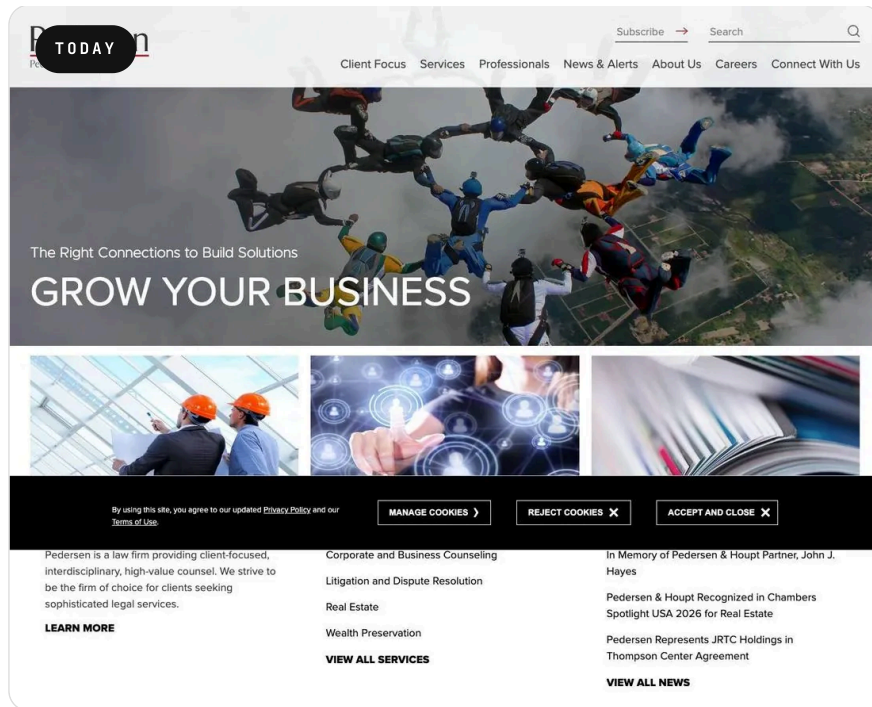
- + Under 2.5 seconds on a phone
- + Titles, descriptions and schema on every page
- + Google Business Profile and directory listings corrected
- + WCAG 2.2 AA, analytics and Search Console

FILL

CONTENT

Photography, copy and the first articles. A new design over old words and mismatched headshots is still the old site.

- + One shoot day at 161 North Clark
 - + Site copy and an edit of every bio
 - + Six launch articles from the firm's own work
 - + A keyword map for each practice
-



Drag to compare. Left, pedersenhoupt.com as it stands. Right, the Matter of record direction from our September audit, which is where design begins in week 2.

BUILT ON

PIECE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY WE'D USE IT
Next.js on Vercel	The site itself	Pages served from a global network, nothing on a server for anyone to patch
A headless CMS	Where your team edits	Bios, matters and articles as fields, so nobody can break the layout. We'd recommend Sanity and confirm it in discovery
Google Analytics 4 and Search Console	Measurement	Keeps the history you already have and adds the search side
Google Business Profile	The map result	For most people searching a firm's name, it is the first thing they see

THE WORK IS DONE. IT ISN'T ON THE **RECORD.**

Most rebuilds pour the old copy into a new template. We'd rather start from what the firm has done and never said. This is what we found in September, and where each piece would go.

CORPORATE • JANUARY 2025

Skolnik Industries, acquired by Pelican Energy Partners

*Counsel to the seller, a
Chicago steel-drum maker*

WHERE IT LIVES TODAY

The buyer's press release on PR Newswire.
Not in your newsroom.

WHERE IT GOES

A matter page, and launch article 02

REAL ESTATE • 2022

The James R. Thompson Center

*Counsel to JRTC Holdings on the
acquisition and the build-to-suit*

WHERE IT LIVES TODAY

One news item, dated November 2025. The
deal was in 2022.

WHERE IT GOES

A matter page with the right date, and article
01

RECOGNITION • 2026

Chambers USA, Real Estate

The firm's first Chambers ranking

WHERE IT LIVES TODAY

One post in August.

WHERE IT GOES

The Real Estate page and every ranked
partner's bio

SPEAKING · JANUARY 2026

Larry Byrne's IICLE webcast

*A program for the state's
continuing legal education institute*

WHERE IT LIVES TODAY

One alert.

WHERE IT GOES

Article 05, written up for the clients who missed it

RESULTS · UNDATED

A \$218M office-to-hotel financing. A U.S. Supreme Court case.

Two of the matters on your results page

WHERE IT LIVES TODAY

Undated lines on one page.

WHERE IT GOES

Matter cards on the practice and attorney pages

PUBLICATIONS · 2001 TO 2022

Twenty-nine articles

Written by the firm's own lawyers

WHERE IT LIVES TODAY

An archive. Nothing new since April 2022, and alerts fell from 22 in 2020 to one to three a year.

WHERE IT GOES

Moved over, dated, tagged by practice, and followed by new ones

For comparison: Levenfeld Pearlstein, Much Shelist, Golan Christie Taglia and Neal Gerber Eisenberg each published new insights in the four weeks before our audit.

THE FIRST BATCH

Six articles, live on launch day. Each one starts with a thirty-minute interview with the partner who did the work. We write it, they approve it, and nothing goes up without their sign-off. We only write from what is already public.

Topics are our proposal. We settle the final six with you in discovery.

01

REAL ESTATE

Buying from the State: what a public seller asks of the buyer

From the Thompson Center acquisition

02

CORPORATE

Selling the family company: what a private equity buyer asks for first

From the Skolnik Industries sale

03

REAL ESTATE & FINANCING

Office to hotel: how a Loop conversion gets financed

From the \$218M redevelopment financing

04

LITIGATION

Before you need it: protecting trade secrets inside a Chicago company

From the firm's trade-secret docket

05

SEMINAR

The January IICLE program, written up

From Larry Byrne's webcast

06

THE FIRM

Sixty-nine years on Clark Street

From Peer Pedersen's founding in 1957 to the office you work in now

ONE DAY AT 161 NORTH CLARK.

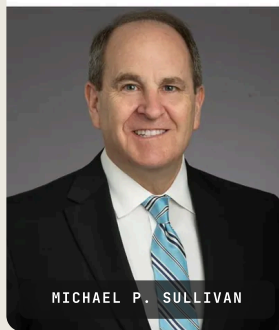
Six partners, four backdrops. Portraits are the most-viewed images on any law firm's site, and today they don't match. One shoot day fixes that and gives the firm photography nobody else has: your office, your building, your street.



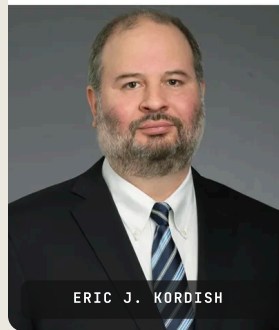
BRIAN P. COLLINS



JOHN H. MUEHLSTEIN



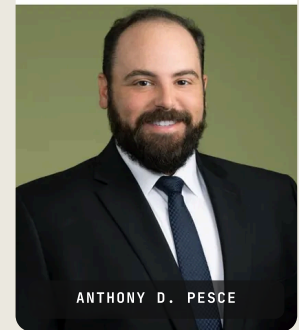
MICHAEL P. SULLIVAN



ERIC J. KORDISH



ASHLEY N. CZAJKOWSKI



ANTHONY D. PESCE

Six partners from your site today, on four different backdrops.

THE SHOT LIST

ON THE DAY

Portraits. Every attorney, one lighting setup, in color, as a full frame and a cut-out.

The office. The floor you designed in 2014, glass walls and working rooms, in use.

The building and the Loop. 161 North Clark, the street, the river. Documentary, never stock.

Details. Hands, files, the reception desk, the things on the shelves.

A two-person crew arrives at 8.

Portraits run ten minutes each, on a schedule we publish a week ahead, so nobody waits.

Office and street shots fill the gaps between portraits.

About 150 retouched selects within five business days, with usage rights for the firm.

THE FOUNDATION UNDERNEATH

✓ **A title and description on every page.** Two of the 169 pages we crawled have one today.

✓ **Structured data** for the firm, each attorney and each practice, so search engines read the site the way a client would.

✓ **Listings that agree with each other.** FindLaw and Lexology still list Suite 3100. Your site says Suite 2700.

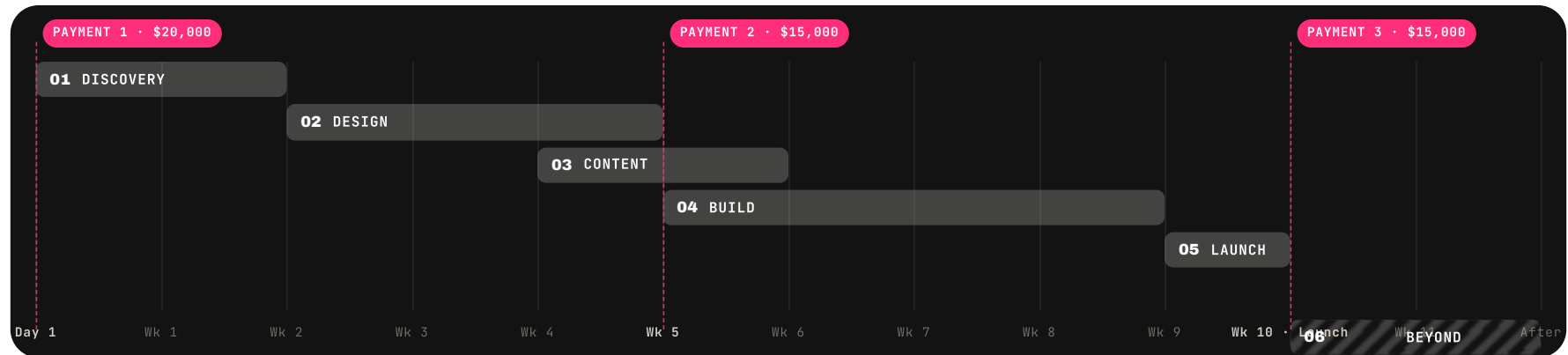
✓ **A redirect for every old address.** Links from directories, old articles and years of email signatures keep working on day one.

✓ **Google Business Profile, claimed.** Today it shows 2.8 stars on four reviews and appears to be unclaimed.

✓ **A keyword map for each practice,** set in discovery and tracked monthly after launch.

TEN WEEKS, DAY ONE TO **LAUNCH.**

Five phases that overlap on purpose. Content starts while design finishes, and the build starts before content is done. Each payment lands on work you've already seen.



01 DISCOVERY & PLANNING

DAY 1 TO WEEK 2

A two-hour kickoff at 161 North Clark, then thirty-minute interviews with the Managing Partner and each practice leader. We read every page in your sitemap, your analytics and your directory listings. You leave this phase with the plan, in writing.

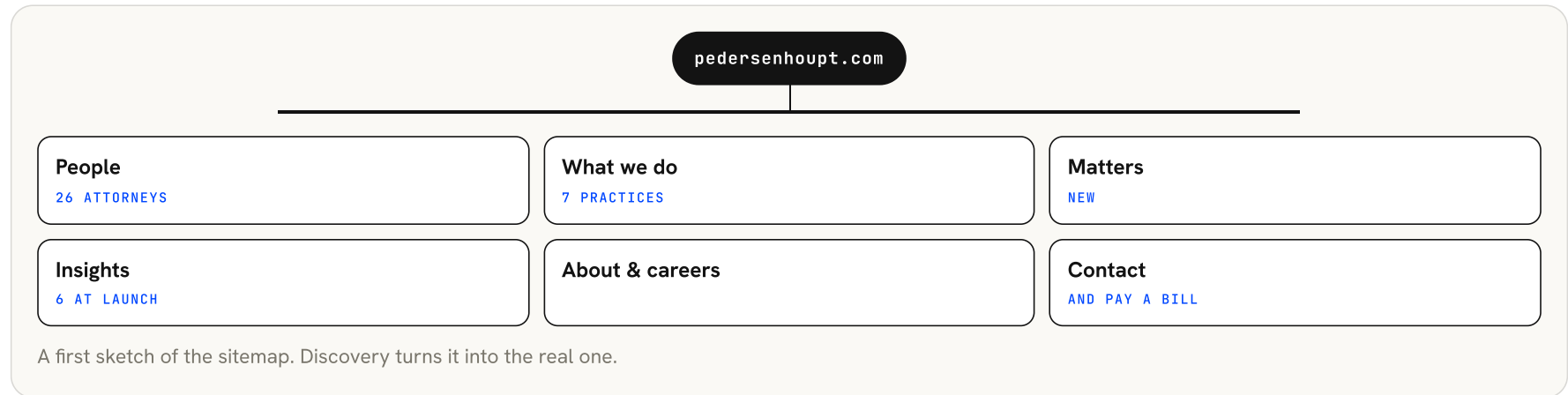
YOU GET

- Sitemap and content model
- A redirect map for every old address
- The shoot plan and a date
- Success measures, signed off

WE NEED FROM YOU

- One point person
- Access to analytics, the domain and the current site's admin
- Thirty minutes from each group leader

PAYMENT 1 At signing, day 1 **\$20,000**



02 DESIGN

WEEKS 2 TO 5

We start from the Matter of record direction you saw in September and turn it into a system: type, color, and the tombstone as a component the whole site can use. Seven templates, desktop and phone, in a prototype you can click. Two rounds of revisions, with one consolidated set of comments from the firm each round.

YOU GET

- The design system
- Seven templates, desktop and phone
- A clickable prototype

WE NEED FROM YOU

- One set of comments per round, within three business days
- A yes on the design by the end of week 5

Pedersen
PEDERSEN & HOUPPT · CHICAGO

PEOPLE WHAT WE DO RESULTS INSIGHTS ABOUT

CLIENT LOGIN PAY A BILL BOOK A CALL

COUNSEL OF RECORD · CORPORATE AND BUSINESS COUNSELING

COUNSEL OF RECORD



Eric J. Kordish
Partner, admitted in Illinois, 2005

Eric J. Kordish

PARTNER · CORPORATE & BUSINESS COUNSELING · REAL ESTATE · LEADS THE CORPORATE GROUP

If you are buying, selling, financing or refinancing a company or a building in Chicago, Eric has closed it before, usually more than once.

HIS MATTERS, AS ANNOUNCED

A MATTER OF RECORD · 2022 AND 2025

\$70M

The Thompson Center, acquired from the State of Illinois by JRTC Holdings; then the Google build-to-suit

Counsel to the purchaser

PEDERSEN & HOUPPT

A MATTER OF RECORD · DOWNTOWN CHICAGO

\$218M

First mortgage, \$92M of new equity and a \$35M mezzanine loan on the redevelopment of an 80-year-old office building into a hotel and offices

Counsel on the financing

Pedersen
PEDERSEN & HOUPPT · CHICAGO

BOOK A CALL

COUNSEL OF RECORD · CORPORATE AND BUSINESS COUNSELING

COUNSEL OF RECORD



Eric J. Kordish
Partner, admitted in Illinois, 2005

Direct 312 261 2249

Email ekordish@pedersenhoupt.com

Office Suite 2700, 161 N. Clark

The attorney page from the September direction. The bio is where a client decides, so it gets the most care.

03 CONTENT

WEEKS 4 TO 6

Two weeks of production, overlapping the end of design and the start of the build. The shoot day at 161 North Clark. Copy for the home, practice, about and careers pages. An edit of every bio. The six launch articles, each from a thirty-minute partner interview, plus a written title and description for every page on the site.

YOU GET

- About 150 retouched photographs
- All site copy, edited bios
- Six approved articles
- A keyword map

WE NEED FROM YOU

- Each attorney at the shoot for their ten minutes
- Thirty minutes from each article's partner
- Sign-off on copy within a week

04 DEVELOPMENT

WEEKS 5 TO 9

We build as each template is approved. Everything moves over: bios, practices, news and the publications archive. Every old address gets a redirect. LawPay, the client login, the newsletter and the forms come across. A staging link lands in your inbox every Friday, so you watch the site come together instead of waiting for a reveal.

YOU GET

- The working site on a private staging link
- The CMS, with your content already in it
- A weekly progress note

WE NEED FROM YOU

- Final copy approvals
- Access to LawPay and the client login provider

05 OPTIMIZE, TEST & LAUNCH

WEEKS 9 TO 10

Speed, accessibility and every device. We test every redirect, train your team on the CMS in an hour with a written guide to keep, and launch on a weekday morning. Then we watch it for two weeks: search, speed, forms, anything that moves.

YOU GET

- The new pedersenhaupt.com, live
- Training and a written guide
- Search Console and your Google profile, verified
- Two weeks of watch after launch

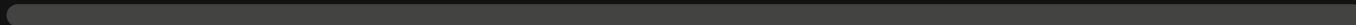
WE NEED FROM YOU

- An hour for training
- A launch date the partners agree on

PAYMENT 3

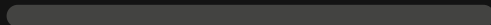
Milestone 2: launch, week 10 **\$15,000**

TODAY



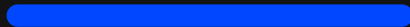
7.8 s

TODAY, BEST RUN



2.8 s

AT LAUNCH



< 2.5 s

Largest element on screen, phone, Lighthouse. The launch number is the target we sign up to in discovery.

06 BEYOND LAUNCH

MONTH THREE ONWARD · OPTIONAL

A site stays current only if someone keeps it that way. After launch, two plans run month to month, and you can stop either one with thirty days' notice.

CARE PLAN

- Hosting and security updates
- Uptime monitoring and backups
- A block of hours each month for changes

CONTENT PROGRAM

- A steady cadence: six articles a month
- Drawn from inbound questions and new matters
- Partner interview, search brief, LinkedIn cut

ONE PROJECT. ONE PRICE.

\$50,000, FIXED.

It covers everything on this page, from the kickoff to two weeks after launch. It is not an estimate and it does not grow with hours. If we've underestimated the work, that is ours to absorb.

The price is itemized so you can see where it goes. The largest share is the build, because a site the firm can edit and keep fast is most of the value. The content lines are the part other proposals leave out.

PAYMENT TERMS

Three payments, each tied to something you can see: 40 percent when we sign, 30 percent when you approve the design at the end of week 5, and 30 percent at launch. Invoices are due in fifteen days.

WHAT WOULD CHANGE IT

A second office, a practice group added mid-build, or something that isn't listed here, like a client portal. We'd quote it separately and before we start, never after.

This proposal holds through October 31, 2026.

PAYMENT 1 • 40%
DAY 1

\$20,000

At signing

PAYMENT 2 • 30%
END OF WEEK
5

\$15,000

Milestone 1: design
approved

PAYMENT 3 • 30%
WEEK 10

\$15,000

Milestone 2: launch

LINE ITEM

FIXED

01	Discovery & planning	\$4,000
	+ Kickoff at 161 North Clark and interviews with the Managing Partner and every practice leader + An audit of every page in your sitemap, your analytics and your directory listings + Sitemap, content model, redirect map and shoot plan, signed off before design starts	
02	Design	\$11,000
	+ A design system built from the Matter of record direction: type, color, the tombstone as a component + Seven templates: home, practice, attorney, matter, article, about and careers, contact + Desktop and phone, a prototype you can click, two rounds of revisions	
03	Development	\$15,500
	+ The build, on a CMS your team edits without calling anyone + Every bio, practice, news item and archived publication moved over + A redirect for every old address, plus LawPay, client login, newsletter and forms	
04	Photography	\$7,500
	+ One shoot day at 161 North Clark with a two-person crew + Every attorney on one light and one crop, plus the office, the building and the Loop + About 150 retouched selects, sized for web, print and LinkedIn, with usage rights for the firm	
05	Copy & SEO	\$6,500
	+ Copy for the home, practice, about and careers pages, and an edit of every bio + A written title and description for every page, and schema for the firm, each attorney and each practice + Google Business Profile claimed and filled out, directory listings corrected, a keyword map per practice	
06	Six launch articles	\$3,000
	+ Written from work the firm has already done and made public + Each one starts with a 30-minute interview with the partner who did the work + Nothing publishes without that partner's sign-off	
07	Optimization, QA & launch	\$2,500
	+ Page speed under 2.5 seconds on a phone, WCAG 2.2 AA on every template + Every device, every redirect, tested + An hour of CMS training, a written guide, and two weeks of watching it after launch	

TOTAL, FIXED FEE

\$50,000

OPTIONAL, AFTER LAUNCH

None of this is required, and none of it is in the \$50,000. Pick what you want and see the monthly figure. Month to month, thirty days' notice to stop.

Care plan

Hosting, security updates, uptime monitoring and backups, a short monthly report, and four hours of changes every month.

\$750

PER MONTH

Content program

Six new articles a month, drawn from the questions clients ask and the matters you close. Partner interview, search brief, and a LinkedIn cut of each.

\$3,600

PER MONTH

New-hire portraits

A half-day session matched to the launch look, so every new attorney arrives on the site looking like the rest of the firm.

\$900

PER SESSION

Feature development

A client portal, a searchable matter database, a recruiting section. Scoped and quoted as a fixed fee before we start, never after.

Quoted

FIXED FEE

A CREATIVE STUDIO RUN BY FOUNDERS.

Upperhand is John Williamson and Greg McDonald. We've spent decades starting, running and selling companies, and building the brands and products inside them. Now we do that work for businesses we believe in, from the first strategy conversation through design and build.

On this project, both of us are in the room the whole way. The people who wrote this proposal are the people who design it, build it and photograph it. Nothing gets handed to a junior team after the contract is signed.

OPERATORS FIRST.

We've sat on the client's side of the table, hired agencies and fired them. So our proposals have a start, an end and a price.

BUILT, NOT HANDED OFF.

We make what we sell. When we say we'll build it, one of us is the person who builds it.

CHICAGO AND BEYOND.

Close enough to be at 161 North Clark for the kickoff and the shoot day, and every other time it helps.

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU SAY YES.

1

TELL US YES

Reply to John, or book a call with both of us to walk through any of it.

2

SIGN

A short services agreement by e-signature, with this scope attached as written.

3

KICK OFF

The first payment, then a kickoff at 161 North Clark within five business days.

4

LAUNCH

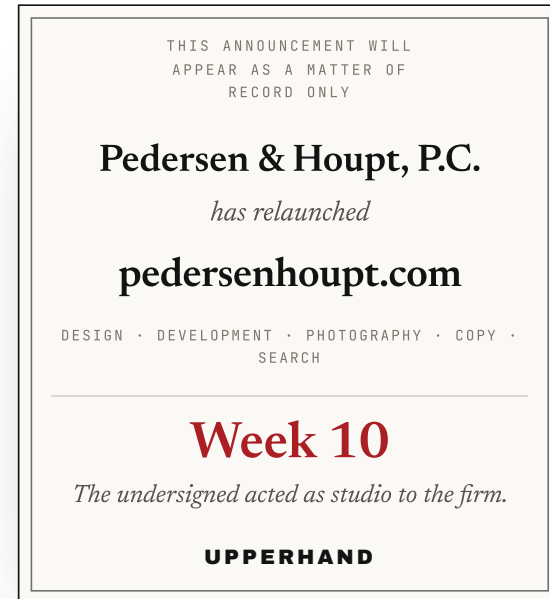
Ten weeks later, the new pedersenhaupt.com goes live.

John Williamson

john@getupperhand.io

Greg McDonald

greg@getupperhand.io



Prepared for Pedersen & Houpt, P.C., September 24, 2026. Confidential. Figures about the current site are from our audit of pedersenhaupt.com in September 2026.

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